

Rhine Hazra

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Key Skills

- Hands-on experience with organic farming, nursery management, and agroecological practices, including work on olive farms, botanical gardens, and farm ecosystem assessments.
- Experience collaborating with smallholder farmers, food distribution organizations, and local residents on development projects like a community cold storage unit, community garden, and village-scale biogas plant.
- Skilled in using Excel, Tableau, PowerBI, Gephi, GIS, & R Programming

Education

Florida Educator Certificate covering Mathematics 6-12

Amherst College, BA in Economics & Architecture, *Summa Cum Laude*

2022 — 2026, GPA: 3.8

+ Architecture Thesis: "From Plan to Plot: Designing for Crisis Response in Community Gardens", earned *Summa Cum Laude*

+ Economics Thesis: "Closing the Poop Loop: The Creation of a Manure Market in India's Gobar Dhan Scheme", earned *Magna Cum Laude*

+ Relevant Courses: Sustainable Design; Urban Economics; Geospatial Analysis; Advanced Econometrics; Data Science; Biology of Food, Fiber & Pharmaceuticals

The School for Field Studies: Center for Sustainable Food Systems

2024, Tuscany, Italy

+ Relevant Courses: Food Systems Resource Management; Food Systems Ecology; Agri-environmental Policy

Relevant Experience

Policy Advocacy Circle @ Hampshire County Food Policy Council

February 2026 — May 2026, Amherst, MA

- Collaborating with a cohort of 20+ community members and organizational partners to advise on the Council's annual Policy Advocacy Plan, targeting improvements to local and Massachusetts food access
- Completing 12+ hours of formal training in public narrative and advocacy strategy for communicating with food justice organizations and local legislators

Partnerships & Development Intern @ Foundation for Food & Agriculture Research (FFAR)

June 2025 — Nov 2025, Washington, D.C.

- Worked with the grants team to migrate donor and partner data from Raiser's Edge to Salesforce
- Designed & implemented a sector prioritization framework scoring 600+ agriculture-related sectors on market size, growth, innovation, and multi-dimensionality including value-chain span and relevance to FFAR's priority areas
- Built automated dashboards and network visualizations in Excel, Tableau, and Gephi to analyze screening results
- Conducted landscape assessment of AI tools (i.e. Inoreader, Feedly, DeepSeek, Gemini, Copilot, beehiiv, HubSpot) and delivered recommendations for automated daily alerts, newsletter generation, and business profile intelligence

Dining Data Fellow @ Amherst College Dining

Oct 2023 — Jun 2024 & May 2025 — Aug 2025, Amherst, MA

- Collaborated with dining administrators and suppliers to assess ~\$3.5 million in food purchases and identify opportunities to source more fresh, locally produced food for the campus community
- Researched local food producers as potential substitutes for large distributors, building relationships between the college and regional farmers

Teaching Assistant for Geospatial Analysis in Developmental Econ @ Amherst College Economics Department

Jan 2025 — May 2025, Amherst, MA

- Mentored students through weekly one-on-one sessions, building their capacity to apply geospatial analysis to real-world development challenges

- Provided technical guidance on using GIS and R for agricultural applications, including analyzing aerial imagery of vegetation and crops

Summer Sustainability Fellow @ Amherst Survival Center

Jun 2024 — Aug 2024, Amherst, MA

- Supervised outdoor operations, including daily distribution of fresh food and meals to 140+ community members
- Designed and implemented a dynamic distribution guide and cold storage system for produce at risk of expiring, reducing food waste by ~ 15 lbs daily

International Work Exchange with World Wide Opportunities on Organic Farms (WWOOF)

Olive Tree Farm Agritourism

Dec 2024, Rhodes, Greece

- Spent 2 weeks helping with daily operations of a multifunctional, family-run agritourism enterprise.
- Helped make artisanal products (olive oil soaps, skin creams, essential oils) from olive harvest to extraction
- Applied organic pest & disease management such as copper to prevent fungi and pheromone-based insect traps

Ornamental Plant Nursery & Botanical Garden

Dec 2024— Jan 2025, Attica, Greece

- Spent 3 weeks helping in propagation, repotting, weeding, and irrigation for over 1,800 plant species, including Mediterranean varieties used in ecological restoration and biodiversity support
- Engaged with green technologies including vertical gardens, green roofs, and biological water purification systems in the greenhouse

Theses

Architecture Thesis: "From Plan to Plot: Designing for Crisis Response in Community Gardens", earned *Summa Cum Laude*

May 2026

I investigate how the latent capacity of community gardens in Holyoke and Springfield, MA determines their ability to become spaces of crisis response during food assistance shocks. I used a mixed-methods framework centered on Importance-Performance Analysis (IPA), evaluating the gap between a garden's planned intent and its lived performance. I synthesized spatial and municipal records, including site plans, zoning documents, grant proposals, and organizational histories, with on-site fieldwork involving behavioral mapping and interviews.

Economics Thesis: "Closing the Poop Loop: The Creation of a Manure Market in India's Gobar Dhan Scheme", earned *Magna Cum Laude*

May 2026

I evaluate the effectiveness of an Indian biogas policy in creating a local manure market for smallholder farmers. I developed a village-level model to analyze how different farm types respond to price signals introduced by village biogas plants. The model was supported by a week-long field survey of biogas plants in Bankura, West Bengal. Empirically, I tested my predictions using a difference-in-differences measuring the effect of access to a biogas plant on chemical fertilizer runoff (as a proxy for chemical fertilizer use). The study provides the first policy evaluation of a biogas program focused on organic fertilizer adoption rather than energy production.

Awards

The Architectural Studies Prize, May 2026, Amherst College

Awarded to the honors thesis judged best by the program for its qualities of clarity and originality in affirming the interdisciplinary richness of architecture.

The James R. Nelson Memorial Award, May 2026, Amherst College

Presented to that senior who, in the opinion of the Economics Department, has achieved excellence in the study of economics while pursuing a broad liberal education.